1, 2, 4, 6

Date: 22 September 2025

Total Marks: 45 marks
Total time: 90 minutes

International Institute of Information Technology - Hyderabad
Academic Year 2025-26 (Monsoon Semester)

LANGUAGE AND SOCIETY [CL2.203]

Mid Semester Exam

Note:

- **Answer all the questions in the answer booklet.**
- **No extra questions to be attempted where choice is given.**
- **No clarifications will be given during the exam.**
- **Your answers should reflect relevant readings and classroom discussions.**

PART I [21 marks]

Read the following 3 conversation snippets taken from Marvel Avengers movies. You may mark the utterances with numbers. You need to submit the question paper as well.

Conversation 1

[at the HYDRA Research Base, Sokovia, Eastern Europe]
Strucker: Who gave the order to attack?
Fortress Soldier: Herr Strucker, it's the Avengers.
Other Fortress Soldier: They landed in the far woods, the perimeter guard panicked.
Strucker: *[to List]* They have to be after the scepter. *[to the soldier]* Can we hold them?
Fortress Soldier: They're the Avengers!
Strucker: Deploy the rest of the tanks.
Fortress Soldier: Yes, sir.
Strucker: Concentrate fire on the weak ones. A hit can make them close ranks.

Conversation 2

[Thor and Loki ride up in the elevator. The atmosphere is tense but familiar.]
LOKI: Here's the thing. I'm probably better off staying here on Sakaar.
THOR: That's exactly what I was thinking.
LOKI: ...Did you just agree with me?
THOR: This place is perfect for you. It's savage, chaotic, lawless. Brother, you're going to do GREAT here.
LOKI: Do you truly think so little of me?
THOR: Loki, I thought the world of you. I thought we were gonna fight side by side forever. But, at the end of the day, you're you, I'm me...
THOR (CONT'D): I don't know, maybe there's still good in you, but let's be honest, our paths diverged a long time ago.
LOKI: It's probably for the best that we never see one another again.
[Thor pats Loki affectionately on the shoulder]

Conversation 3

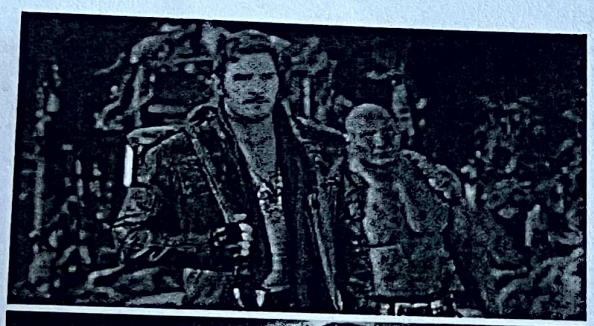
Peter Quill [Looking at unconscious Thor]: How the hell is this dude still alive?
Drax: He is not a dude. You're a dude. This... This is a man. A handsome, muscular man.
Peter Quill: I'm muscular.
Rocket: Who are you kidding, Quill? You're one sandwich away from fat.
Peter Quill: Yeah, right.
Drax: It's true. You have gained a little weight... (Drax motions to his chin and belly)

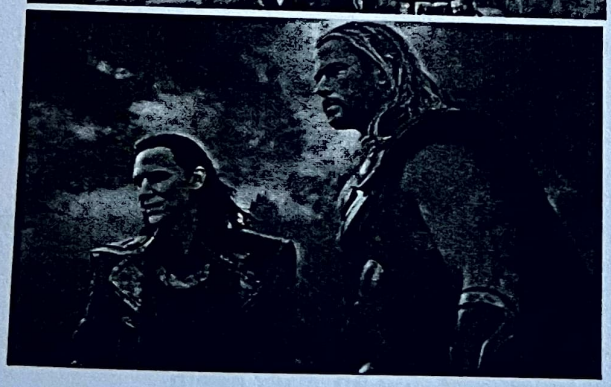
(i) Across all conversations, compare and analyse the data following the metrics of social factors and social dimensions. [4+4 marks]

(ii) Describe how social context influence language/code choices and engage in humor/sarcasm. [4 marks]

(iii) For analysing the given data, share whether having watched the films previously give additional advantage? How? [2 marks]

(iv) Translate any one conversation in an Indian language you know and share your observation of capturing the pragmatic nuances across cultures. Translation need not be perfect. [3 +4 marks]





MARVEL STUDIOS
AVENGERS
INFINITY WAR

PART II [4 x 6 = 24 marks]

Choose to answer **any four questions**. Give examples wherever necessary.

1. Why do speakers sometimes flout the Gricean Maxims? What are some examples, and how do listeners interpret or respond? In what ways can these violations contribute to humor, identity, or status negotiation?

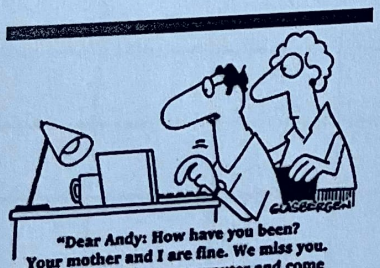
2. What are the differences between positive and negative politeness? How can different politeness strategies help build solidarity or show respect for independence? Give real-life examples to illustrate how politeness can both aid and sometimes hinder communication. Share language choices for politeness strategies.

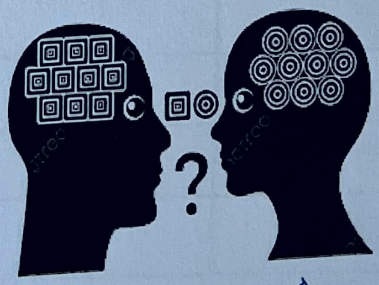
3. What factors lead to communication breakdowns or failures? How do turn-taking, adjacency pairs, or assumptions play a role in these misunderstandings? Explain the need to learn about cross-cultural communication techniques when one travels.

4. What distinguishes High (H) and Low (L) varieties in diglossic contexts? Why do vernacular forms of speech arise, and how do social factors influence such language choice?

5. How do social networks (density, plexity, uniplex vs. multiplex ties) influence individuals' speech patterns? In what ways can networks lead to phenomena such as pidgins and creoles?

6. What are contextualisation cues, and why are they significant in discourse analysis? How do cues (intonation, gesture, medium of communication, etc.) guide interpretation in conversation? How might different media (e.g., memes vs. printed jokes) affect humor's role in community building and social critique?





Gricean
Social / pragmatics
Social / language

intimate distant
social status subordinate
formality informal
function affect

...from other students in the examination hall is prohibited.

...cheating or copying in the examination hall, the student will be given 'F' grade